Onboarding a channel, and getting paid for its ads

What happens when a partner hands Asiko an HLS feed — where it plugs in, and how the ad revenue is split.

01

A channel arrives in one of three shapes

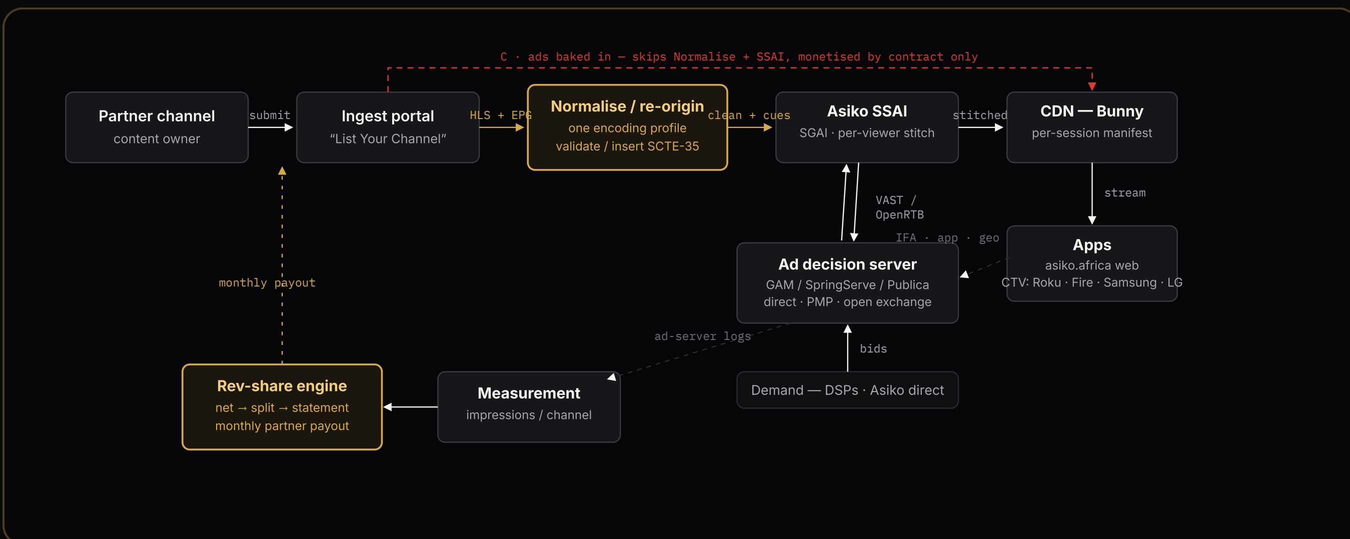
The shape it arrives in decides how Asiko earns from it. This is the single most important thing to nail in the "List Your Channel" agreement.

INTAKE	WHAT THE PARTNER SENDS	WHO INSERTS THE ADS	HOW ASIKO EARNS	ASIKO'S POSITION
A · Clean feed	Live HLS of the programme only + `SCTE-35` ad-break markers + EPG (XMLTV / MRSS)	**Asiko** — our SSAI fills every break	We sell / auction all inventory, then rev-share back to the partner	Strongest — full control & measurement
B · Files + schedule	Transcoded VOD assets (or a growing library) + a playlist / schedule feed	**Asiko** — we build the linear channel (Channel Engine), insert our own SCTE-35, run SSAI	Same as A — we own monetisation end to end	Strongest — we also own playout
C · Ads baked in	Live HLS with the partner's ads *already stitched* — one finished channel	**Partner** (or their aggregator) — we can't address their pods	Contract only: reserved pods, audited rev-share, or a flat carriage fee	Weakest — no measurement hook

Push every partner to A or B. Accept C only for a channel you really want, and only with one of the three contractual mechanisms in §4 — never on a handshake "we'll share what we make".

02

The pipeline



Clean feed (intake A / B, gold path): the partner HLS + EPG enter at *Normalise / re-origin* — that is where you plug it in — it is conditioned to one profile with valid SCTE-35, then Asiko SSAI fills each break by calling the ad decision server per viewer. The ad server takes programmatic demand and logs every impression to Measurement, which drives the rev-share engine and the monthly partner payout. **Baked-in feed (intake C, red path):** there is nothing to insert into — it skips Normalise and SSAI, goes straight to the CDN, and is paid by contract, not by measured impressions.

03

Where the HLS plugs in

The connection point is the **Normalise / re-origin** stage — not the player, not the CDN. The partner gives you a pull URL (their HLS manifest) and an EPG feed; you pull from it and re-originate a clean stream your SSAI can trust.

Why it can't go straight to SSAI or the player

- **Rendition consistency.** Manifest-based ad stitching splices ad segments into the content stream. If the partner's video ladder (resolutions, codecs, keyframe cadence, audio) doesn't match your ad renditions, playback breaks at every splice. Normalisation forces one profile across content and ads.
- **SCTE-35 conditioning.** Ad breaks must be signalled in the manifest as `#EXT-X-CUE-OUT/IN` or `EXT-X-DATERANGE`. If the partner sends clean markers, you validate them; if they can't, you insert cue points from their EPG / a schedule adapter.
- **A stable origin.** Their URL might move, throttle, or geo-block. Re-origination gives you one predictable origin behind Bunny, and one place to enforce failover to a slate.

On the platform we're using, this stage is **Eyevinn Channel Engine** — file/schedule mode for intake B, or a pass-through / re-origination role for intake A — with the **SGAI Pipeline** as the SSAI layer immediately after.

04

Getting a share of the revenue

A / B — clean feed or files: Asiko monetises, then shares back

- Your ad server reports **net ad revenue per channel** (gross minus the SSP / ad-server take, usually a few percent of media spend).
- Contractual split on that net — FAST norm is **content owner 50–70% / platform 30–50%**, tuned by how much the channel drives tune-in and by exclusivity.
- Asiko also carries the **CDN egress** cost (Bunny) — factor it into the split or bill it separately.
- Paid monthly against the ad-server report; the partner gets a statement showing impressions, fill, eCPM and their share by channel.

C — ads baked in: four ways to still earn

- **Reserved pods (best).** Contract requires the partner to leave a set share of ad minutes — e.g. every 3rd slot, or 30–50% of pod time — as *addressable avails marked with SCTE-35*. You DAI your own ads into only those slots. The break becomes `[partner ad · ASIKO ad · partner ad]`. You measure and keep 100% of your pods; the partner may still pay an override.

- **Audited rev-share.** Partner sells everything, sends you a reconciled impressions/revenue report from *their* ad server, pays you an agreed % (often 10–30%). Needs an audit clause and, ideally, read access to their ad-server reporting.
- **Flat carriage.** A fixed monthly fee per channel (either direction), no revenue link. Simplest, lowest ceiling — use it for long-tail channels.
- **Sponsorship around the content.** You sell what their pods don't touch — channel presenting-sponsor, EPG placement, home-row promotion, lower-thirds / L-bar on your app. Pure Asiko revenue, no split.

> Reserved pods are the only C-model option that gives you real, measured, programmatic upside. If a partner won't mark avails for you, treat them as flat-carriage and price accordingly.

05

CTV, AVOD & programmatic notes

- **SSAI, not client-side.** On CTV there is no ad blocker to defeat, but there's also no reliable client ad SDK across Roku / Tizen / webOS / Fire TV. Server-side stitching is the only thing that renders an ad frame-accurately on every device and survives the 10-foot app.
- **What the ad request carries.** Per break, SSAI sends the ad server: device ad id (IFA / RIDA / LGUDID), app bundle + name, content genre / rating / channel, coarse geo, IP, and pod structure (slots × duration). That's what makes the impression addressable and worth a CTV CPM.
- **AVOD (on-demand).** Same SSAI, different trigger — pre-roll + mid-roll cue points on the asset instead of a live SCTE-35 stream. One ad stack serves both linear and on-demand.
- **Ad server choice.** `SpringServe` is the FAST-native default (built for CTV pods, good SSAI integrations). `Publica` (by IAS) is the unified-auction SSP many FAST platforms sit on. `Google Ad Manager` if you already live in Google's stack. Asiko picks one; Enveu (or we) integrate it behind the SSAI.
- **Fill.** New FAST channels rarely fill 100% programmatically. House promos and direct-sold sponsorship backfill unsold avails — which is exactly what the POC's revenue

panel models.

06

What the “List Your Channel” spec must require

- **Feed:** HLS (TS or CMAF), a named encoding profile, keyframe cadence stated, stereo + described-audio where available.
- **Ad signalling:** SCTE-35 in-manifest on every break, or an EPG precise enough to derive cue points; declared pod structure.
- **Ad policy:** clean / reserved-pods / baked-in — stated up front, with the reserved-pod share if C.
- **EPG:** XMLTV or MRSS, now + next + at least 24–72h forward, updated on change.
- **Rights:** territories, music clearance, any content that must be blacked out.
- **Brand assets:** channel logo (SVG + PNG on transparent), a fallback slate.
- **Reporting access:** for C-audited deals, read access to their ad-server reporting or a signed monthly reconciliation.

Asiko TV — channel onboarding & ad revenue

Companion to the revised architecture (Eyevinn-native SSAI) and the asiko.africa design spec

Prepared for Media Icons Africa · 5 September 2026